

Alexandra Chen

Senior Software Engineer

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Results-driven software engineer with 8+ years of experience building scalable distributed systems and developer tooling. Proven track record of leading cross-functional teams, shipping high-impact products at scale, and contributing to open-source infrastructure. Passionate about performance optimisation, developer experience, and mentoring early-career engineers.

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineer — Meridian Systems, San Francisco

Jan 2022 – Present

- Architected a real-time event-processing pipeline handling 2 M+ messages per second using Apache Kafka and Go, reducing P99 latency by 43%.
- Led migration from monolithic Ruby on Rails service to a micro-frontend architecture with React and TypeScript, cutting average page load time from 4.2 s to 1.1 s.
- Directed a team of six engineers through quarterly planning, sprint execution, and incident response rotations; mentored two junior developers to mid-level promotion.
- Introduced automated canary deployments with feature flags, achieving zero-downtime releases for 18 consecutive months.

Software Engineer — Aurora Dynamics, Boston

Jun 2019 – Dec 2021

- Developed simulation and visualisation tools in Python and C++ for guidance, navigation, and control subsystems of autonomous aerial vehicles.
- Built a CI/CD pipeline with GitHub Actions and Docker that reduced average build–test–deploy cycle from 45 min to 12 min.
- Co-authored three internal technical standards on flight-software testing adopted across two programme offices.

Junior Engineer — Polaris Labs, Austin

Aug 2017 – May 2019

- Implemented RESTful APIs and database schemas for an IoT fleet management platform serving 500+ connected devices.
- Contributed to an open-source MQTT broker used by 1 200+ stars on GitHub; authored documentation and example projects.

Education

- **M.S. Computer Science** — Stanford University, 2017. Thesis: “Adaptive Scheduling Strategies for Heterogeneous Stream Processing.”
- **B.S. Applied Physics** — University of Texas at Austin, 2015. Magna Cum Laude.

Skills

Languages Go, Python, TypeScript, Rust, C++, SQL

Infrastructure Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS, GCP

Data Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch

Practices CI/CD, SRE, TDD, code review, agile

Selected Publications

1. A. Chen, M. Rivera, “Adaptive Windowing for Low-Latency Stream Joins,” *Proc. VLDB Endowment*, vol. 15, no. 4, pp. 891–904, 2022.
2. A. Chen, K. Nguyen, “Graceful Degradation in Distributed Actor Systems,” *Proc. ACM SIGPLAN Int. Conf. on Functional Programming*, pp. 112–124, 2021.

Languages

English (Native), Mandarin Chinese (Professional Working), Spanish (Conversational)